

Local-Unitary Rigidity and Clifford Geometry of Six-Qudit AME Stabilizer Tensors

Tavis Rudd

July 2026

Abstract

Let C be a linear $[6, 3, 4]_q$ MDS code and let $|\Psi_C\rangle = q^{-3/2} \sum_{c \in C} |c\rangle$ be its equal-phase CSS state. We prove that every product-unitary intertwiner between two such states is local Clifford, for every prime power q . The proof shortens the stabilizer to four parties. Its nonidentity correlation tensor is diagonal on all $q^2 - 1$ local Weyl axes, and the rank-one contraction locus recovers those axes intrinsically. We apply this rigidity to an odd-characteristic non-Reed–Solomon pencil of six-point arcs. Projective, monomial-code, local-Clifford, and local-unitary equivalence are all classified there by one degree-eight quotient z . We also determine the split-torus versus $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$ logical-Clifford phase, give exact marginal and four-copy local-unitary certificates, prove generic constancy of every fixed-copy scalar contraction on algebraic code families, and derive the rank-jump divisor $(z - 2)(9z - 4)$ from a four-sheet transport operator.

1 Introduction

An absolutely maximally entangled state has maximally mixed reductions on every subsystem no larger than half the parties. At minimum support, a six-party state of local dimension q is naturally supplied by a length-six MDS code: if $C \leq \mathbb{F}_q^6$ is linear of dimension three, then

$$|\Psi_C\rangle = q^{-3/2} \sum_{c \in C} |c\rangle \quad (1.1)$$

is $\mathrm{AME}(6, q)$ exactly when C is $[6, 3, 4]_q$ MDS. This code–state dictionary is standard [RGRA18]. Our question is how much of the code geometry survives arbitrary single-party changes of basis.

The local-unitary versus local-Clifford problem is false for general stabilizer states [JCWY10]. It is therefore important that the following result concerns a specific MDS/CSS family and says more than equality of two orbit partitions.

Theorem 1.1 (Local-unitary rigidity). Let q be a prime power and let $C, D \leq \mathbb{F}_q^6$ be linear $[6, 3, 4]_q$ MDS codes. Suppose that, for a party permutation π , single-qudit unitaries $U_1, \dots, U_6$, and a phase θ ,

$$(U_1 \otimes \dots \otimes U_6) \pi |\Psi_C\rangle = e^{i\theta} |\Psi_D\rangle.$$

Then every U_i normalizes the finite-field Weyl system. In particular, the displayed equivalence is local Clifford.

The mechanism is visible in one reduced operator. Shortening both C and $C^\perp$ to four parties gives a q^2 -element stabilizer subgroup. At each retained party its $q^2 - 1$ nonidentity elements run bijectively through the nonidentity Weyl operators. After the identity term is removed, the four-party reduced state is therefore a diagonal four-way tensor on the full Weyl

basis. A contraction of such a tensor has rank one exactly on its coordinate axes. Those axes are intrinsic, so any product unitary carrying one reduced state to another must permute the local Weyl axes. This is precisely the Clifford condition.

Rains used the corresponding three-Pauli tensor to determine the automorphisms of qubit distance-two codes [Rai99, Theorem 13], and Van den Nest, Dehaene, and De Moor used that rigidity in their minimal-support criterion for qubit stabilizer states [VdNDDM05]. Our argument is a finite-field extension of this axis-recovery mechanism. To our knowledge, it gives the first LU-to-LC theorem in the exact scope of equal-phase CSS states from linear $[6, 3, 4]_q$ MDS codes, uniformly over prime-power q . The qualifier is essential: arbitrary phased minimal-support AME(6, d) states form infinitely many LU classes [RL25], and neither non-linear orthogonal arrays nor general six-qudit stabilizer states are covered here.

Our main application is the ordered pencil

$$H_t = ((0, 1, 1 - t), (0, 1, t - 1), (1, 1 - t, 0), (1, t - 1, 0), (1, 0, -t), (1, 0, t)). \quad (1.2)$$

On its admitted odd-characteristic non-GRS locus, define

$$\begin{aligned} A(t) &= -4t(t - 1)^2, \\ B(t) &= (t^2 - t + 1)(t^2 - 3t + 1), \\ z(t) &= (B(t)/A(t))^2. \end{aligned} \quad (1.3)$$

Exact bracket identities show that z is the degree-eight projective quotient of the pencil. Theorem 1.1 upgrades its local-Clifford classification to the following complete local result.

Corollary 1.2 (Classification of the admitted pencil). For admitted parameters t, u over any finite field of odd order, the following are equivalent:

$$H_t \sim_{\text{proj}} H_u \iff \ker H_t \sim_{\text{mon}} \ker H_u \iff \Psi_t \sim_{\text{LC}} \Psi_u \iff \Psi_t \sim_{\text{LU}} \Psi_u \iff z(t) = z(u),$$

where party permutations are allowed.

The rest of the paper separates classification from explicit scalar certificates. Section 2 fixes the arc, code, Weyl, and AME conventions. Section 3 proves the headline theorem. Section 4 proves the z -classification, and Section 5 determines the logical-Clifford phase: $\text{SL}_2(q)$ on the GRS locus and a split torus off it. Section 6 gives a uniform H3/GRS marginal separator, an exact four-copy $q = 13$ witness, and the generic-constancy obstruction for fixed-copy scalars. Section 7 derives the exceptional divisor of the four-copy witness from a nine-dimensional transport operator. Section 8 records the computational trust boundary and the precise scope of all results.

2 Six-arcs, MDS codes, and CSS states

Let $q = p^e$ and fix the additive character $\chi(a) = \exp(2\pi i \text{Tr}_{\mathbb{F}_q/\mathbb{F}_p}(a)/p)$. On the standard basis of $\mathbb{C}^q$, indexed by $\mathbb{F}_q$, put

$$X(a)|x\rangle = |x + a\rangle, \quad Z(b)|x\rangle = \chi(bx)|x\rangle.$$

For $v = (a, b) \in \mathbb{F}_q^2$, write $W_v = X(a)Z(b)$, with any fixed consistent phase convention. The q^2 operators W_v form an orthogonal basis of the single-party Hilbert–Schmidt space. A unitary is Clifford when conjugation permutes their projective axes $\mathbb{C}W_v$.

A six-arc is an ordered sextuple of points of $\mathbb{P}^2(\mathbb{F}_q)$ with no three collinear. Choose nonzero column representatives and collect them in a 3-by-6 matrix H . The arc condition says that every three-column minor of H is nonzero. Consequently

$$C = \ker H \leq \mathbb{F}_q^6$$

is an $[6, 3, 4]_q$ MDS code, and its dual $C^\perp = \text{rowspace } H$ is MDS with the same parameters. Conversely, a parity-check matrix of such a code supplies a six-arc. Projectivities, independent rescaling of columns, and permutation of columns correspond exactly to monomial equivalences of the kernels.

Proposition 2.1 (Arc-AME dictionary). For a six-arc with kernel C , the state $|\Psi_C\rangle$ in (1.1) is a minimal-support stabilizer $\text{AME}(6, q)$ state. Its projective Pauli-label Lagrangian is

$$L_C = (C \oplus 0) + (0 \oplus C^\perp) \leq \mathbb{F}_q^{12}.$$

Monomial code equivalence, together with a party permutation, induces local-Clifford equivalence of the corresponding states.

Proof. The operators $X(c)$, $c \in C$, fix the equal superposition. The operators $Z(h)$, $h \in C^\perp$, fix it because $\chi(h \cdot c) = 1$. The two subgroups commute, and their label space has dimension six and is Lagrangian.

For any three-coordinate set I , puncturing C to I is bijective: injectivity follows from distance four and both spaces have dimension three. In the partial trace of $|\Psi_C\rangle\langle\Psi_C|$, equality on the complementary three coordinates therefore forces equality of the codewords, while the projection to I runs once through $\mathbb{F}_q^3$. Hence every three-party reduction is $q^{-3}I$. Smaller reductions are maximally mixed by tracing again, so the state is $\text{AME}(6, q)$. Its support has the minimum possible size q^3 .

A column multiplier $x \mapsto ax$ is a single-party Clifford operation: it sends $X(b)$ to $X(ab)$ and $Z(b)$ to $Z(a^{-1}b)$. Projective row operations do not change the kernel, and column permutations permute parties. This proves the last assertion. $\square$

For a party set S , let

$$L_C(S) = \{\ell \in L_C : \text{supp}(\ell) \subseteq S\}.$$

The stabilizer partial-trace formula gives

$$\rho_S^C = q^{-|S|} \sum_{\ell \in L_C(S)} W_\ell. \quad (2.1)$$

This formula is the bridge used in both the rigidity proof and the marginal invariants below. A Pauli-labelled quantity is not by itself an LU invariant; the invariant statements will always be expressed either as covariance of the reduced operators or as basis-free tensor contractions.

The GRS boundary has a simple geometric meaning. A dimension-three length-six generalized Reed-Solomon code is represented, up to column multipliers, by six points on a nonsingular conic in $\mathbb{P}^2$. We use “GRS state” for the state of any such code. The non-GRS pencil in Section 4 consists of arc matrices H_t away from that conic locus and from the other factors needed to keep the columns distinct and the displayed coordinates defined.

3 Four-party Weyl tensors and LU rigidity

We first isolate the linear-algebra statement that recovers a diagonal tensor’s coordinate axes. It is the full-Weyl counterpart of the three-Pauli argument in [Rai99, VdNDDM05].

Lemma 3.1 (Diagonal-tensor axes). Let $r \geq 3$, let $E_1, \dots, E_r$ be N -dimensional complex inner product spaces, and choose orthonormal bases $\{e_{ij} : 1 \leq j \leq N\}$. If

$$T = \sum_{j=1}^N \lambda_j e_{1j} \otimes \cdots \otimes e_{rj}, \quad \lambda_j \neq 0, \quad (3.1)$$

then the coordinate axes in every E_i are intrinsic to T . Consequently, a product of invertible linear maps carrying one tensor of the form (3.1) to another is monomial in the displayed bases.

Proof. Contract the first factor against $x = \sum_j x_j e_{1j}^*$. The result is

$$T_x = \sum_j \lambda_j x_j e_{2j} \otimes \cdots \otimes e_{rj}.$$

Flattening from E_2 to $E_3 \otimes \cdots \otimes E_r$ gives a matrix of rank $\#\{j : x_j \neq 0\}$. Thus T_x has rank one exactly when x lies on a coordinate axis. Product equivalence preserves this rank-one contraction locus, and hence permutes the axes in the first factor. Apply the same argument in every factor. $\square$

Fix a four-party set S . Shortening an $[6, 3, 4]$ MDS code on the two coordinates outside S leaves a one-dimensional code. Choose nonzero shortened words $c^S \in C$ and $h^S \in C^\perp$. Each has support exactly S , and

$$L_C(S) = \{(ac^S, bh^S) : a, b \in \mathbb{F}_q\}. \quad (3.2)$$

At a party $i \in S$, projection of this plane to the local Pauli labels is

$$(a, b) \mapsto (ac_i^S, bh_i^S),$$

which is invertible because both coordinates are nonzero. Thus the $q^2 - 1$ nonidentity labels in $L_C(S)$ run bijectively through the nonidentity Weyl labels at every party of S .

Proposition 3.2 (A four-party marginal fixes the local Weyl axes). If a product unitary on S carries ρ_S^C to ρ_S^D , then every one of its four local factors is Clifford.

Proof. Subtract the identity term from (2.1) and view the result as a tensor in the four local Hilbert–Schmidt spaces. By (3.2), after indexing the nonzero label $v = (a, b)$, it has the form

$$T_S^C = \sum_{v \in \mathbb{F}_q^2 \setminus \{0\}} \lambda_v W_{L_1 v} \otimes W_{L_2 v} \otimes W_{L_3 v} \otimes W_{L_4 v}, \quad (3.3)$$

where every L_i is invertible and every coefficient λ_v is nonzero. This is a diagonal tensor with $N = q^2 - 1$.

Local conjugation fixes the identity and acts unitarily on each Hilbert–Schmidt space. Lemma 3.1 therefore forces each local adjoint action to permute the axes $\mathbb{C}W_v$, $v \neq 0$. It also fixes the identity axis, so the underlying unitary normalizes the projective Weyl group. This is the single-qudit Clifford condition. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.1. Absorb the party permutation by relabelling D . Partial trace of the six-party equivalence gives a product-unitary equivalence $\rho_S^C \sim \rho_S^D$ for every four-set S . Given a party i , choose a four-set containing it and apply Proposition 3.2. Thus every U_i is Clifford. $\square$

Only two marginals are needed if their supports cover all six parties; for example $S = \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$ and $S' = \{1, 2, 5, 6\}$. More generally, the proof applies whenever every party belongs to a support of size at least three whose supported stabilizer subgroup has order q^2 and projects bijectively onto all nonzero local Weyl labels. We use only the $[6, 3, 4]$ MDS specialization.

4 The non-GRS pencil and its quotient

Let H_t be the ordered matrix in (1.2), over a finite field of odd order, and put

$$G(t) = t^4 - 4t^3 + 7t^2 - 4t + 1.$$

The admitted non-GRS condition is

$$t(t-1)(t^2-t+1)(t^2-3t+1)G(t) \neq 0. \quad (4.1)$$

The first four factors keep the displayed arc and quotient coordinates nondegenerate; $G = 0$ is the conic, hence GRS, boundary. Write $C_t = \ker H_t$ and $\Psi_t = \Psi_{C_t}$, and let A, B, z be as in (1.3).

Theorem 4.1 (Projective and Clifford quotient). For admitted t, u , the following are equivalent:

$$H_t \sim_{\text{proj}} H_u, \quad C_t \sim_{\text{mon}} C_u, \quad \Psi_t \sim_{\text{LC}} \Psi_u, \quad z(t) = z(u),$$

allowing arbitrary party permutations.

Proof. Set

$$y(t) = \frac{(t-1)^2}{t}.$$

Then $A = -4t^2y$, $B = t^2(y^2 - 1)$, and

$$z = \frac{(y - y^{-1})^2}{16}.$$

It follows that $z(t) = z(u)$ exactly when

$$y(u) \in \{y(t), -y(t), y(t)^{-1}, -y(t)^{-1}\}. \quad (4.2)$$

Each of the four relations is realized by a direct projectivity and a party permutation. In order, one may use

relation	projectivity
$y(u) = y(t)$	$\text{diag}(1, (1-u)/(1-t), u/t)$
$y(u) = -y(t)$	$\text{diag}(1, (1-u)/(1-t), -u/t)$
$y(u) = y(t)^{-1}$	$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & (u-1)/t \\ 0 & -u/(1-t) & 0 \end{pmatrix}$
$y(u) = -y(t)^{-1}$	$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & (1-u)/t \\ 0 & -u/(1-t) & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$

The corresponding permutations are respectively the identity, (56), (35)(46), and (3546). All denominators and determinants are nonzero on the admitted locus.

Conversely, the ten signed products of complementary 3-by-3 brackets of H_t form the multiset

$$\{+A, +A, +A, -A, -A, -A, +B, +B, -B, -B\}. \quad (4.3)$$

Projectivity and independent column rescaling multiply all ten products by one common scalar; party permutation changes at most their common sign. The multiplicities three and two in (4.3) recover $(B/A)^2 = z$. Hence projective equivalence forces equality of z . The equivalence with monomial codes follows from Section 2, and projective equivalence supplies an LC equivalence.

For the remaining direction, shorten the Pauli-label Lagrangian to every four-set. Projection between the local two-dimensional label planes defines transition maps; comparing

two supports gives a holonomy matrix. The multiset of conjugacy-and-inversion invariants $\text{Tr}(M)^2/\det M$ is preserved by LC and party permutation. Its 450 entries have exact values

$$\begin{array}{c|c} 4 & 90 \\ -1/z & 144 \\ (2z+1)^2/z^2 & 24 \\ \text{each root of } X^2 - 8X + (8 - 16z - 1/z) & 96. \end{array} \quad (4.4)$$

Away from the GRS value $z = -1/4$, the multiplicity pattern identifies $-1/z$, including every modular collision. Thus LC equivalence forces equality of z . $\square$

The map $t \mapsto z$ has degree eight: the four transformations in (4.2), followed by the quadratic relation $t+t^{-1} = y+2$, account for its eight sheets. The signed refinement $w = B/A$, $z = w^2$, is not quantum data. Both even and odd explicit party permutations reverse w , and their projectivities lift to monomial local Cliffords.

Proof of Corollary 1.2. Theorem 4.1 gives all equivalences except LU. Every LC is an LU, while Theorem 1.1 turns every LU intertwiner between the states Ψ_t, Ψ_u into an LC intertwiner. $\square$

5 The logical-Clifford phase

Regard any one party of an $\text{AME}(6, q)$ stabilizer tensor as an input and the other five as outputs. This is a $[[5, 1, 3]]_q$ encoding isometry. A tensor symmetry fixing every party induces a one-qudit logical symplectic transformation in that view.

Theorem 5.1 (Logical phase). For an equal-phase CSS state from a six-arc over a field of odd order, the fixed-party symplectic kernel is

$$\begin{cases} \text{SL}_2(q), & \text{if the arc is conic/GRS,} \\ T = \{\text{diag}(a, a^{-1}) : a \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times\}, & \text{if the arc is nonconic.} \end{cases} \quad (5.1)$$

Thus every encoder view of a GRS tensor realizes the full one-qudit logical Clifford group from fixed-party symmetries. Off the GRS locus, the fixed-party logical group is the split torus; adding party-moving isodualities gives its normalizer.

Proof. Every four-party support carries the two-dimensional shortened label plane (3.2), and projection to the Pauli plane of any retained party is an isomorphism. For a fixed party permutation, one anchor block in $\text{SL}_2(q)$ therefore forces the other five local symplectic blocks through overlaps of the shortened supports. Satisfying all support relations is necessary and sufficient for preserving the full Lagrangian.

Diagonal anchor blocks always propagate and give T . If an anchor has a nonzero off-diagonal entry, the overlap equations force a coordinatewise scaling equivalence between C and $C^\perp$. In the arc language, the labelled six-arc must be fixed by Gale association. For six points in $\mathbb{P}^2$, that fixed divisor is precisely the conic locus. On a conic, the usual GRS dual multipliers propagate every anchor in $\text{SL}_2(q)$; off the conic, only diagonal anchors survive. $\square$

The distinction is operational rather than a classical automorphism count. Including logical Paulis, the projective logical Clifford group has order $q^2|\text{SL}_2(q)|$ on the GRS locus, whereas the non-GRS encoder view has $q^2 \cdot 2(q-1)$ after the party-moving normalizer is included. At $q = 11$, these orders are 159720 and 2420, respectively.

The MDS property also makes minimum operator pushing uniform. For any input party and nonidentity Pauli label, each of the ten four-sets containing that party gives a unique

stabilizer representative supported there. Removing the input leaves a weight-three output Pauli. Thus each input Pauli has exactly ten minimum-support pushes, although the symmetry orbits of those pushes can distinguish finer projective classes.

Arithmetic symmetry jumps do not change the phase. The characteristic-17 tetrahedral specialization lies on the GRS boundary and retains the full $\mathrm{SL}_2(17)$ kernel. The characteristic-31 non-GRS A_5 specialization retains only the split torus. These are symmetry enhancements inside the two phases, not exceptions to (5.1).

6 Explicit local-unitary invariants

Theorem 1.1 settles equivalence without scalar invariants. Scalar witnesses remain useful because they are short, basis-free certificates and because their failures explain what the operator-valued marginal retains.

6.1 A marginal-moment separator

For a four-party set T , let ρ_T be the reduced state and embed it into all six parties as

$$A_T = \rho_T \otimes I_{T^c}.$$

For an unordered triple $\{T, U, V\}$, the number $\mathrm{Tr}(A_T A_U A_V)$ is invariant under arbitrary product unitaries; party permutation merely permutes the 455 triples. By (2.1),

$$\mathrm{Tr}(A_T A_U A_V) = q^{-\mathrm{rank}(L_C(T) + L_C(U) + L_C(V))}. \quad (6.1)$$

Index a four-set by its omitted pair, an edge of K_6 . The rank in (6.1) is four exactly when the three corresponding chord lines concur in both the six-arc $\mathcal{A}$ and its Gale dual $\mathcal{A}^*$. Sixty triples are stars and concur universally. The only other possible contributors are the fifteen perfect matchings. Hence

$$\#\{q^{-4} \text{ moments}\} = 60 + b(\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{A}^*), \quad (6.2)$$

where b counts perfect matchings concurrent in both configurations.

Theorem 6.1 (Uniform H3/GRS separation). Let $\tau^2 = \tau + 1$, and reduce the integral H3 six-arc

$$((0, 1, 1 - \tau), (0, 1, \tau - 1), (1, 1 - \tau, 0), (1, \tau - 1, 0), (1, 0, -\tau), (1, 0, \tau))$$

in an odd good residue field. If the reduction is non-GRS, its equal-phase state is not LU-equivalent, even after party permutation, to any six-point GRS state over the same field.

Proof. Exact integral chord determinants give ten common concurrent matchings for the H3 arc and its Gale dual. The other five determinant norms are -64 and -4 , so the count is exactly ten in every odd good reduction. The H3 moment multiset therefore contains 70 copies of q^{-4} .

For six points S on a conic, a concurrent perfect matching is the orbit pairing of a fixed-point-free involution in $\mathrm{Stab}_{\mathrm{PGL}_2(q)}(S)$. A projectivity fixing three points is the identity, so this group acts freely on ordered triples and its order divides 120. The finite subgroups of PGL_2 , including the small wild-characteristic cases, show that outside characteristic five the number of fixed-point-free involutions is in

$$\{0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 6\}.$$

Thus a GRS state has at most 66 copies of q^{-4} . In characteristic five the exceptional 120-element action has ten, but the H3 reduction is itself GRS there and is excluded by the theorem's hypothesis. Equation (6.1) is LU-invariant, so the gap proves the claim. $\square$

The five nonconcurrent H3 matchings form a one-factorization of K_6 . The marginal incidence recovers its S_5 stabilizer but forgets the even A_5 orientation. This is necessary: full local Fourier transform sends Ψ_C to $\Psi_{C^\perp}$, and an integral isoduality returns the H3 code through an odd pentad permutation in every odd reduction. The orientation is an LC-forgettable CSS electric/magnetic marking, not a separate LU class.

6.2 The exact dimension-thirteen four-copy witness

For m ket copies and m bra copies, choose a permutation $\sigma_i \in S_m$ at each party and contract ket copy a with bra copy $\sigma_i(a)$. If G generates a three-dimensional code, let $M_\sigma(G)$ be the homogeneous matching system

$$(u_a G)_i = (v_{\sigma_i(a)} G)_i \quad (1 \leq i \leq 6, 1 \leq a \leq m).$$

Counting its solutions gives the normalized contraction

$$I_\sigma(\Psi_C) = q^{3m - \text{rank } M_\sigma(G)}. \quad (6.3)$$

Theorem 6.2 (Exact four-copy separator at $q = 13$). The two admitted $q = 13$ pencil classes with $z = 4$ and $z = 12$ are not local-unitary equivalent, even after arbitrary party permutation.

Proof. At $q = 13$, the admitted pencil has two classes in the same complete three-copy and marginal-moment bucket, with $z = 4$ and $z = 12$. For one explicit four-copy pattern, sum (6.3) over all party permutations:

$$J_\sigma(\Psi) = \sum_{\pi \in S_6} I_{\pi\sigma}(\Psi).$$

The $z = 4$ class has rank 21 for all 720 terms. The $z = 12$ class has rank 20 for 192 terms and rank 21 for 528. Therefore

$$J_\sigma(z = 4) = 720 \cdot 13^{-9}, \quad J_\sigma(z = 12) = 3024 \cdot 13^{-9}. \quad (6.4)$$

This proves arbitrary-LU inequivalence directly. The complete two- and three-copy contraction sets do not separate this pair; (6.4) makes no claim that four copies are globally minimal. $\square$

6.3 Why fixed-copy scalars cannot recover the pencil coordinate

Proposition 6.3 (Generic constancy). Fix m . On any algebraic family of equal-phase states of linear codes, every degree- (m, m) permutation contraction is constant on a dense open rank stratum. The same holds for party-orbit sums and linear combinations. In the stable range $q \geq m$, all scalar LU invariants of bidegree (m, m) are generically constant on the family.

Proof. Formula (6.3) depends only on the rank of a matrix whose entries are regular functions of the family parameter. A maximal nonzero minor shows that this rank is constant on a dense open set. There are only finitely many diagrams at fixed m , so their generic-rank opens have a common dense intersection. In the stable Schur–Weyl range the local permutation diagrams span the multilinear LU invariants, proving the last statement. $\square$

For the pencil, the field generated by the generic four-copy contraction values is therefore constant, not $\mathbb{Q}(z)$. The witness (6.4) detects a rank-jump stratum. In contrast, the four-party operator tensor (3.3) retains the Weyl axes and forces Cliffordness. This is the precise distinction between scalar blindness and marginal covariant rigidity.

7 The four-copy transport operator

We now explain the rank jump behind (6.4). Fix the six copy permutations

$$\sigma = (1, (03)(12), (23), (02)(13), (01)(23), (021)).$$

Let V be the three-dimensional message space and let $g_i : V \rightarrow k$ be the six coordinate covectors. Form a bipartite four-sheeted cover with vertices L_a, R_b , $0 \leq a, b < 4$, and a color- i edge from L_a to $R_{\sigma_i(a)}$. Put V at each vertex and k at each edge, using $g_{p(i)}$ as both restriction maps for a party assignment $p \in S_6$. A global section is a tuple $(x_a, y_b) \in V^8$ satisfying

$$g_{p(i)}(x_a - y_{\sigma_i(a)}) = 0 \quad (7.1)$$

on all 24 edges. The three-dimensional constant-section space is always present. Gauging it away leaves the 24-by-21 matching matrix in (6.3).

Let $U = k^4/k(1, 1, 1, 1)$, and let ρ_i be the action of σ_i on U . In systematic code coordinates the first three rows are

$$Q = \begin{pmatrix} a & b & c \\ a & c & b \\ d & d & d \end{pmatrix}, \quad \begin{aligned} a &= -2(t-1)^2, & b &= -(t^2 - t + 1), \\ c &= -(t^2 - 3t + 1), & d &= -2(t-1). \end{aligned}$$

If $Y_k \in U$ are the three free copy vectors, then (7.1) reduces to the 9-by-9 block transport operator

$$T_p = (Q_{ik}(\rho_i - \rho_{3+k}))_{i,k=0}^2. \quad (7.2)$$

The dimension identity

$$21 - \text{rank } M_p = 9 - \text{rank } T_p \quad (7.3)$$

holds over every field where the pencil is defined.

Theorem 7.1 (Transport divisor). On the admitted odd non-GRS pencil, the sheaf (7.1) has a nonconstant section exactly on

$$(B^2 - 2A^2)(9B^2 - 4A^2) = 0,$$

or equivalently

$$(z - 2)(9z - 4) = 0. \quad (7.4)$$

At a generic point above $z = 2$, exactly 96 party assignments have rank 20; at a generic point above $z = 4/9$, exactly 192 do. Every other assignment has rank 21.

Proof. The coefficients satisfy

$$a = b + c, \quad d^2 = -2a, \quad A = a(c - b), \quad B = bc.$$

Expanding $\det T_p$ by signed cycle covers gives three nonboundary relative-cover types:

$$\begin{aligned} P_- &= AB(3B - 2A), \\ P_+ &= AB(3B + 2A), \\ P_2 &= A(B^2 - 2A^2). \end{aligned}$$

With integral bases the determinants are respectively

$$64d^3 AB(3B - 2A), \quad 64d^3 AB(3B + 2A), \quad 64d^3 A(B^2 - 2A^2).$$

All omitted factors are units on the admitted odd pencil. The two signed types lie above $w = B/A = \pm 2/3$, hence $z = 4/9$; the third lies above $z = 2$. Fraction-free elimination independently gives the same determinants and shows that the generic kernel is one-dimensional.

The active party assignments form single double cosets. For $z = 2$, their size is

$$\frac{|S_4 \times C_2| |D_8 \times C_2|}{|C_2^3|} = \frac{48 \cdot 16}{8} = 96.$$

For either signed $z = 4/9$ sheet, their size is

$$\frac{|S_4| |S_4 \times C_2|}{|S_3|} = \frac{24 \cdot 48}{6} = 192.$$

The two signed double cosets are disjoint. Equation (7.3) turns the one-dimensional transport kernels into rank 20 of the matching matrix and completes the proof. $\square$

The exceptional arithmetic belongs to this detector, not to Theorem 1.1. The exact boundary is:

char k	effect on the transport divisor	
2	outside the odd-field pencil	
3	both admitted detector components disappear	
5	$z = 4/9$ lies on the excluded GRS boundary; $z = 2$ remains	(7.5)
7	the two components merge; the rank histogram is $20^{288}21^{432}$	
11, 13, 41	pullback ramification only; no further rank drop.	

At $t = -1$, $A = 16$, $B = 15$, and the nonboundary exceptional primes are already visible in

$$B^2 - 2A^2 = -7 \cdot 41, \quad 9B^2 - 4A^2 = 7 \cdot 11 \cdot 13.$$

The divisor records where one scalar contraction changes rank. It is not an LU-orbit boundary and, by Proposition 6.3, cannot be promoted to a generic coordinate.

8 Verification, literature, and scope

The rigidity theorem, the arc-AME dictionary, and generic constancy are conceptual proofs in the text. The projective quotient uses displayed bracket identities and projectivities; its modular collision closure, the finite logical-group checks, the H3 incidence counts, the $q = 13$ contractions, and the transport multiplicities also have exact paper-local certificates.

The reproducibility package is in `supplement/`. From that directory,

```
python3 verify.py          checks all fifteen byte counts and SHA-256 digests,
python3 verify.py --replay regenerates all seven canonical JSON certificates in memory.
```

The full replay uses only the Python standard library, deterministic integer, rational, polynomial, and finite-field arithmetic, and canonical JSON serialization. It includes independent paths appropriate to each claim: CSS versus direct-Lagrangian shortening, symbolic versus finite projectivity, chord concurrency versus stabilizer ranks, quotient minors versus finite-field elimination, and cycle-cover versus fraction-free transport determinants. The exact files, hashes, domains, expected outputs, and negative scopes are recorded in `supplement/EVIDENCE.md` and `supplement/EVIDENCE-MANIFEST.json`.

The trusted boundary is Python integer arithmetic, the exact-arithmetic implementations in the generators, deterministic Gaussian elimination, and the mathematical dictionaries connecting arcs, codes, stabilizers, and tensor contractions. The certificates check the bounded

enumerations and symbolic identities that they record. They do not prove the conceptual correspondence between the implemented objects and the paper definitions; that correspondence is supplied in the preceding sections.

The LU-to-LC mechanism has direct qubit ancestry. Rains recovered the three Pauli axes of distance-two code projectors [Rai99]; Van den Nest, Dehaene, and De Moor used minimal stabilizer supports to force every local factor of an LU equivalence to be Clifford [VdNDDM05]. General minimal-support AME equivalence permits behavior outside our equal-phase CSS hypotheses [BR20, RL25]. Our qualified novelty claim is only the full $q^2 - 1$ -axis, prime-power-qudit extension and its uniform $[6, 3, 4]_q$ MDS/CSS specialization. It is not a new LU-LC mechanism in the abstract.

Finally, none of the results classifies nonlinear orthogonal arrays, arbitrary minimal-support AME tensors, non-MDS stabilizer states, or all stabilizer states over prime-power dimensions. We do not claim that four copies are globally minimal, that $z = 2, 4/9$ are orbit exceptions, or that a fixed copy degree separates all classes as q varies. The logical-group theorem is restricted to the stated odd-field six-arc domain, the H3 theorem to odd good non-GRS reductions, and the detector exceptions in (7.5) do not alter the characteristic-uniform rigidity theorem.

References

- [BR20] Adam Burchardt and Zahra Raissi. Stochastic local operations with classical communication of absolutely maximally entangled states. *Physical Review A*, 102:022413, 2020.
- [JCWY10] Zhengfeng Ji, Jianxin Chen, Zhaohui Wei, and Mingsheng Ying. The LU-LC conjecture is false. *Quantum Information & Computation*, 10(1–2):97–108, 2010.
- [Rai99] Eric M. Rains. Quantum codes of minimum distance two. *IEEE Transactions on Information Theory*, 45(1):266–271, 1999.
- [RGRA18] Zahra Raissi, Christian Gogolin, Arnau Riera, and Antonio Acín. Optimal quantum error correcting codes from absolutely maximally entangled states. *Journal of Physics A: Mathematical and Theoretical*, 51:075301, 2018.
- [RL25] Nithin Ramadas and Arul Lakshminarayan. Local unitary equivalence of absolutely maximally entangled states constructed from orthogonal arrays. *Journal of Physics A: Mathematical and Theoretical*, 2025.
- [VdNDDM05] Maarten Van den Nest, Jeroen Dehaene, and Bart De Moor. Local unitary versus local Clifford equivalence of stabilizer states. *Physical Review A*, 71:062323, 2005.